

Special Creation Of Humanity

doc-special-creation-of-humanity
Anthropology · Historicity · doctrine · divided_lineages

AFFIRMS

score 1.000
confidence high

Statement under examination

Adam and Eve were specially created by God and are not the product of unguided evolutionary processes.

In plain language

Genesis tells the origin of Adam and Eve with a cluster of verbs that name God as the personal agent. Bara, the creation verb the Hebrew Bible reserves for God (a query of all its occurrences finds no human or natural subject), appears three times in Gen 1:27 with the human as the direct object. Before that, Gen 1:26 uses a deliberate let us make, not the impersonal commands of earlier days, and assigns the human the image and likeness of God, which nothing else receives. Yatsar, the potter verb, shapes the man from dust in Gen 2:7, and God blows the breath of life into his nostrils, at which point the man becomes a living being. Banah, the building verb, makes the woman from the man's side. Ps 100:3 adds the plain negation, he made us and not we ourselves, and the New Testament keeps the same grammar: Jesus says the creator made them male and female (Matt 19:4) and Paul says Adam was first formed, using the Greek verb that translates the Hebrew potter verb (1 Tim 2:13). So the words decisively say humanity is God's deliberate work, not a self-originating accident. Why do careful readers still divide? The divergence is lexical, not historical. The very verb used of forming the man, yatsar, is also used of God forming a person in the womb (Jer 1:5, Isa 44:2, Ps 139:16), and that forming clearly runs through an ordinary process over time. The same word, dust, and the verb to breathe are common terms whose strong creation sense here comes from context. So the vocabulary settles who acts and that the act is deliberate and personal, but it does not by itself state the physical manner, whether the forming was instantaneous or worked through a means. One reading takes the verbs as immediate, hands-on acts. The other reads them as affirming divine agency while leaving the mechanism open. Both reject an unguided, agentless origin, which is the heart of what the proposition claims, and that is why the verdict affirms.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0120	אָדָם	adam	man	562
H0127	אֲדָמָה	adamah	land	
H0802	אִשָּׁה	ishshah	woman	
H1129	בָּנָה	banah	to build	340
H1254	בָּרָא	bara	to create	46
H1823	דְּמוּת	demuth	likeness	24
H2145	זָכָר	zakar	male	80
H2416	חַיָּה	chay	alive	
H3318	יָצָא	yatsa	to come out	

H3335	יָצַר	yatsar	to form	61
H5301	נָפַח	naphach	to breathe	11
H5347	נִקְבָּה	neqebah	female	22
H5397	נִשְׁמָה	neshamah	breath	23
H5462	סָגַר	sagar	to shut	
H6083	עָפָר	aphar	dust	97
H6213	עָשָׂה	asah	to make	
H6754	צֶלֶם	tselem	image	16
H6763	צֶלַע	tsela	side	40
H8639	תַּדְמָה	tardemah	deep sleep	7
G2936	κτίζω	ktizo	to create	15
G4111	πλάσσω	plasso	to mold	2
G4160	ποιέω	poieō	to do/make	

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The lexical pattern across Gen 1:26-27, Gen 2:7, and Gen 2:21-22 names God as the direct and personal agent of humanity's origin, and the witness reaches the New Testament. Four verbs carry the load: bara (H1254A, queried across all 39 verses with God as the only subject) creates the human and is repeated three times in Gen 1:27 with the human as eth-marked direct object; yatsar (H3335, the potter verb) forms the man from dust; naphach (H5301) blows the breath of life into his nostrils; banah (H1129) builds the woman from his side. Matt 19:4 (ktizo, poieo) and 1 Tim 2:13 (plasso, the Greek mirror of yatsar) restate Adam and the man-female pair as a divine making, so the spread is pan-canonical. The reading that the words affirm divine agency without specifying biological mechanism is also lexically defensible, since yatsar is used of God forming individuals in the womb (Jer 1:5, Isa 44:2, Ps 139:16), which is a real mediate process. The affirmed point (direct divine agency) is decisive; the question of mechanism is what the vocabulary underdetermines.

Scripture

Gen.1.26 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. H6213A עָשָׂה, H6754 צֶלֶם, H1823 דְּמוּת, H0120 אָדָם.

Force. The clause naaseh adam (let us make man) uses a deliberate first-person volitive of asah, which sets the human-making apart from the impersonal jussives that produce the prior days. The pair tselem and demuth assigns the human a categorial likeness to God that no other created thing receives. The verb here names intention and personal resolve, not a process. It tells who acts and with what purpose, but it does not by itself specify the physical manner of execution.

Gen.1.27 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. H1254A בָּרָא, H6754 צֶלֶם, H2145 זָכָר, H5347 נִקְבָּה.

Force. Bara occurs three times in this single verse with Elohim as subject and the human as direct object marked by the accusative particle eth. A direct query of all 39 verses where bara (H1254A) appears confirms that it never takes a human or natural subject in the canon, it is reserved for divine action. Male and female (zakar, neqebah) are both named at the originating creation event, not introduced as a later branch. The grammar fixes God as the agent. It does not in this verse describe the bodily steps of the making.

Gen.2.7 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H3335 יצר, H6083 עפר, H5301 נפח, H5397 נשמה

Force. Wayyitser (yatsar) is the potter verb. God forms the man of dust (aphar) from the ground, then blows (naphach) the neshamah of life into his nostrils, and only at that point does the man become a living nephesh. The clause order makes the divine breath the proximate cause of human animation. A full concordance pull of yatsar (54 distinct verses) shows the same verb used of God forming the prophet in the womb (Jer 1:5) and forming Israel from the womb (Isa 44:2, Isa 44:24, Isa 49:5), processes that unfold through ordinary gestation, so yatsar names personal divine craftsmanship without fixing whether the forming is immediate or works through a means.

Gen.2.21 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H8639 תרדמה, H6763 צלע, H5462 סגר

Force. Tardemah is a divinely induced deep sleep, the same noun used in Gen 15:12 of the covenant theophany with Abram (confirmed by query, 7 occurrences total). God takes a tsela (side or rib) from the man and closes (sagar) flesh in its place. The verbs narrate a concrete, intentional, hands-on act rather than a figurative cause or a gradual emergence.

Gen.2.22 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H1129 בנה, H6763 צלע, H0802 אשה

Force. Banah, the verb for building or constructing (340 occurrences, normally of houses, cities, and altars), governs the formation of the woman from the side material taken from the man. The grammar makes the woman a derived but discrete act of divine construction with God as the named builder, not a parallel line that arose on its own.

Gen.2.19 · **complicates** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H3335 יצר, H0127 אדמה

Force. The same verb wayyitser (yatsar) used of the man in Gen 2:7 is also used here of the land animals and birds, formed by God from the ground. This shows that the forming verb alone is not what marks the human as special. What is not repeated for any animal is the breathing of God's own neshamah and the threefold bara of Gen 1:27. This text complicates a naive reading that leans only on yatsar, and it also constrains the evolutionary reading, because the animals too are said to be formed directly by God from the ground.

Gen.1.24 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H3318 יצא, H2416E תיה

Force. The land animals are produced by a mediated formula, totse haarets (let the earth bring forth) using the causative of yatsa. This is a different construction from the human-making, which uses bara plus eth-adam and the personal naaseh. The contrast within Gen 1 itself, mediated bringing-forth for the animals versus direct creation language for the human, sharpens rather than weakens the directness claimed for the human.

Gen.3.19 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H6083 עפר, H0127 אדמה

Force. The judgment oracle confirms the Gen 2:7 origin by returning the man to the dust he was taken from, ki apha' attah (for you are dust). The apha' idiom is treated as a real statement of where the man came from, not as poetic dress, and it assumes the original forming as an actual event.

Gen.5.1 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H1823 דמות, H0120 אדם

Force. The toledoth header of adam restates that on the day God created adam he made him in the demuth of God. The genealogical header treats Gen 1 and Gen 2 as a single historical origin point for the human line, with God as maker.

Jer.1.5 · neutral · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H3335 יצר.

Force. Before I formed you (yatsar) in the womb I knew you. Here the identical potter verb describes God forming an individual person through ordinary gestation in the womb (ba-beten). This is the strongest lexical basis for the reading that yatsar affirms personal divine forming without by itself excluding a mediate biological means. It does not overturn the directness in Genesis, but it shows the verb does not settle the question of mechanism.

Isa.44.2 · neutral · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H3335 יצר, H6213A עשה.

Force. The LORD your maker (osekha) and your former (yotserkha) from the womb (mi-beten). The same verb pair, asah and yatsar, that operates in the Genesis human-making is here applied to God forming a person from the womb. This is part of the lexical evidence that the forming vocabulary asserts divine agency over a person's origin while remaining compatible with a process that runs in time.

Ps.139.16 · neutral · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H3335 יצר.

Force. My days were formed (yatsar, passive) when as yet there were none. The verb of Gen 2:7 is used of the shaping of a life across time. This further shows that yatsar names God's purposeful forming of a person without specifying an instantaneous manner, which is the genuine point the Genesis vocabulary leaves open.

Job.27.3 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H5397 נשמה.

Force. Job locates his own continuing life in the neshamah in his nostrils and the ruach of Eloah, recycling the exact Gen 2:7 vocabulary. The wisdom text treats the Gen 2:7 breath as the ongoing description of every living human, which presses the originating divine breath as a real cause and not a figure.

Gen.7.22 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. H5397 נשמה, H2416E תיה.

Force. The flood narrative uses neshamath ruach chayyim (the breath of the spirit of life) in the nostrils to describe what dies, presupposing the Gen 2:7 source of that breath as the common origin of human and creaturely life.

Isa.43.7 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H1254A ברא, H3335 יצר, H6213A עשה.

Force. Isaiah stacks all three Genesis verbs on the same human object, beratiw (I created him), yetsartiw (I formed him), aph asitiw (indeed I made him). The triple chain gathers the Gen 1 and Gen 2 vocabulary together and insists that God is the agent of the human's existence. The piling of synonyms intensifies the agency claim without itemizing the physical steps.

Ps.100.3 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H6213A עשה.

Force. He made us (asanu) and not we ourselves. The negation places the cause of human existence outside human agency and assigns it to God as maker. It directly excludes a self-originating account, which is the contrast the proposition's negation targets.

Matt.19.4 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G2936 κτίζω, G4160 ποιέω

Force. Jesus says the one who created (ho ktisas) from the beginning made them (epoiesen autous) male and female (arsen kai thelu), directly echoing the zakar and neqebah of Gen 1:27. This carries the same agent-and-act grammar into the New Testament and attributes the male and female pairing to a personal creator at the beginning, which gives the doctrine an OT and NT spread.

1Tim.2.13 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4111 πλάσσω

Force. Adam was first formed (protos eplasthe, from plasso), then Eve. Plasso is the standard Greek mold-or-shape verb and the regular Septuagint rendering of yatsar. Applying eplasthe to Adam restates the Gen 2:7 potter-forming in Greek and ties the New Testament directly to the Genesis vocabulary, with God as the implied forming agent.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Gen.2.21	Gen.15.12	tsk	1
Gen.2.22	Gen.2.19	tsk	1
Gen.1.27	Gen.2.21	tsk	1
Gen.2.7	Gen.3.19	tsk	1
Gen.1.26	Gen.5.1	tsk	1
Gen.2.7	Job.27.3	tsk	1
Gen.2.7	Ps.100.3	tsk	1
Gen.2.7	Gen.7.22	tsk	1
Gen.1.27	Isa.43.7	openbible	1
Gen.1.27	Matt.19.4	openbible	1
Gen.1.26	Ps.100.3	openbible	1
Gen.1.26	Acts.17.26	openbible	1
Gen.1.27	Ps.139.14	openbible	1

Complicating texts

Gen.2.19 · addressed

The animals are also formed (yatsar) by God from the ground, so the forming verb alone does not single out the human. The distinguishing features are the threefold bara of Gen 1:27, the eth-marked direct object, the image-and-likeness assignment, and God breathing his own neshamah into the man, none of which is repeated for any animal. The human special-creation reading therefore rests on the cluster, not on yatsar by itself.

Jer.1.5 · addressed

Yatsar is used of God forming an individual in the womb (ba-beten), a process that runs through ordinary gestation, and the same womb-forming use appears in Isa 44:2, Isa 44:24, Isa 49:5, and Ps 139:16. This shows the verb predicates personal divine agency over a person's origin but does not by itself fix whether the forming is instantaneous or works through a means. The proposition's affirmed core (direct divine agency) holds; the additional claim about excluding any mediate process is what the vocabulary leaves open. This is recorded as a genuine, fairly stated competing lens rather than a defeater.

Gen.1.24 · addressed

Land animals are produced by the mediated totse haarets formula (let the earth bring forth), which is grammatically distinct from the direct bara plus naaseh language used of the human. The contrast supports the directness claimed for the human-making and does not undercut it.

Concordance traversed

H1254A, H3335, H5301, H5397, H1129, H6754, H1823, H6083, H6763, H8639, H2145, H5347, H0120, H0127, H6213A, G4111, G2936, G4160

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: n/a

The anchor verses are in Genesis, outside the ingested ECM window (3 John). Gen 1 and Gen 2 sit in the Masoretic and Samaritan Pentateuch consonantal stream with no variant readings that touch the bara, yatsar, naphach, neshamah, tsela, or banah anchors. The New Testament witnesses cited (Matt 19:4 ktizo and poieo, 1 Tim 2:13 plasso) have no variant that changes which creation verb is used. CBGM is not applicable to these verses.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. young_earth_creationism, old_earth_creationism, theistic_evolution, framework_hypothesis

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

direct_special_creation: affirms · Reads the verb cluster (bara three times, the personal naaseh, yatsar from dust, naphach of the breath, banah of the woman from the rib) as discrete, hands-on divine acts that produced the first human pair immediately, with the contrast against the mediated totse haarets of the animals and the unique image-and-likeness assignment confirming that the human origin is told as a direct creative event rather than the terminus of a natural sequence.

divine_agency_without_specified_mechanism: affirms_agency · Agrees that the words make God the personal agent of humanity's origin, but holds that the same verbs do not by themselves specify the physical manner. The strongest lexical support is that yatsar, the Gen 2:7 verb, is used of God forming individuals in the womb (Jer 1:5, Isa 44:2, Isa 44:24, Isa 49:5, Ps 139:16), a process that unfolds through ordinary gestation, and that aphar (dust) and naphach (blow, breathe) are common-language terms whose Gen 2:7 sense comes from context. On this reading the text decisively affirms that humanity is God's deliberate work and not self-originating, while leaving the biological mechanism unaddressed by the vocabulary itself. This lens still rejects an unguided, agentless account, because Ps 100:3 (he made us, not we ourselves) and the eth-marked bara of Gen 1:27 keep God as the cause.

The proposition has two parts: a positive claim (specially created by God) and a negation (not the product of unguided processes). Both competing lenses affirm the positive divine-agency claim and both reject an unguided, self-originating account, so the verdict affirms on the part the lexis decides. The lenses differ only on whether the vocabulary also forecloses any mediate process, which is the point the words underdetermine. Chronology frameworks (young earth, old earth, framework) do not change the agency reading and are listed as frameworks_in_play but are not the axis of divergence.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem pairs a positive claim (Adam and Eve specially created by God) with a negation (not the product of unguided evolutionary processes). The negation names the actual contrast the lexis resolves, namely whether the verbs identify a deliberate divine agent or an agentless natural process, so it does not smuggle the verdict. The lexical pattern decides the agency question on its own terms. No rephrasing was needed. Affirms is unchanged from the prior file (still true); the enrichment deepened the underdetermination analysis and added the New Testament witnesses, it did not flip the verdict.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.1.27
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.2.7
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.2.19
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.2.22
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H1254A
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H3335
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H5301
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H1129
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H5397
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4111
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2936
interlinear	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.1.26-27
interlinear	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.2.7
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	1Tim.2.13
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Gen.2.7
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Gen.1.27
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Gen.1.26

License audit

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OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
TSK	public_domain	yes
OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes

Flags

(none)